



REDUCING **FORGOTTEN** **REPLIES** IN WHATSAPP CONVERSATIONS

How might we help users respond to important messages after reading them when a reply is still pending?

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PRODUCT **PRINCIPLES** FOR WHATSAPP

- Real-time conversations between individuals and groups
- Secure conversations with end-to-end encryption
- Used daily for time-sensitive personal and business communication

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

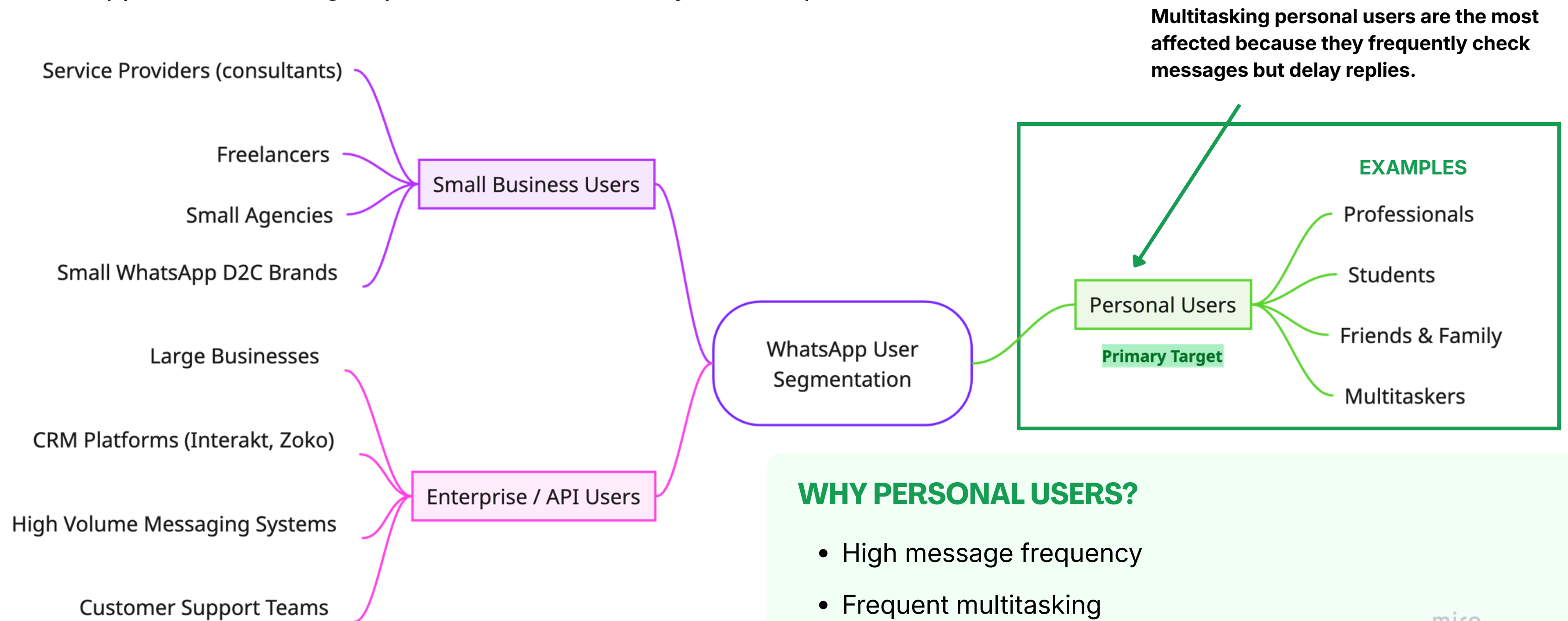
- Simple
- Reliable
- Minimal interface

KEY TAKEAWAY

Any new feature must **improve communication reliability** while preserving WhatsApp's simple and minimal interface.

USER SEGMENTATION OF WHATSAPP USERS

WhatsApp users can be grouped based on how they use the platform.



WHY PERSONAL USERS?

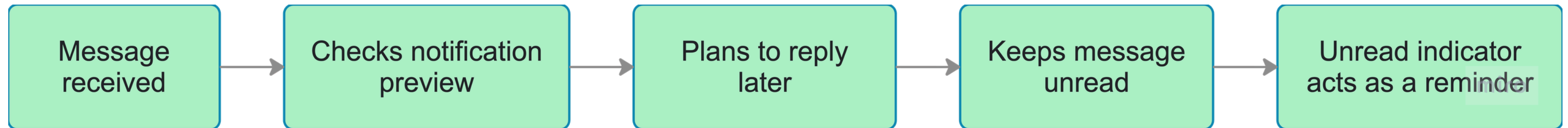
- High message frequency
- Frequent multitasking
- Most likely to read messages without replying
- Lack structured conversation management tools

miro

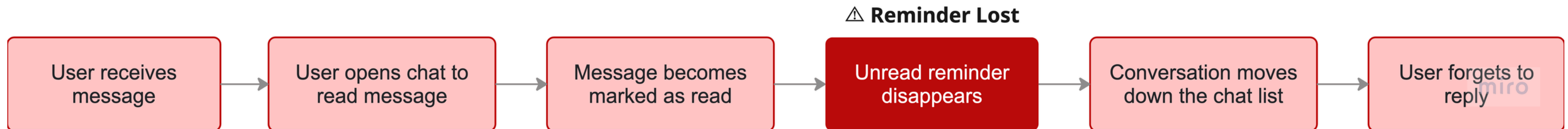
WHY **REPLIES GET FORGOTTEN** ON WHATSAPP

Based on user survey and behavior workflow analysis

USER STRATEGY



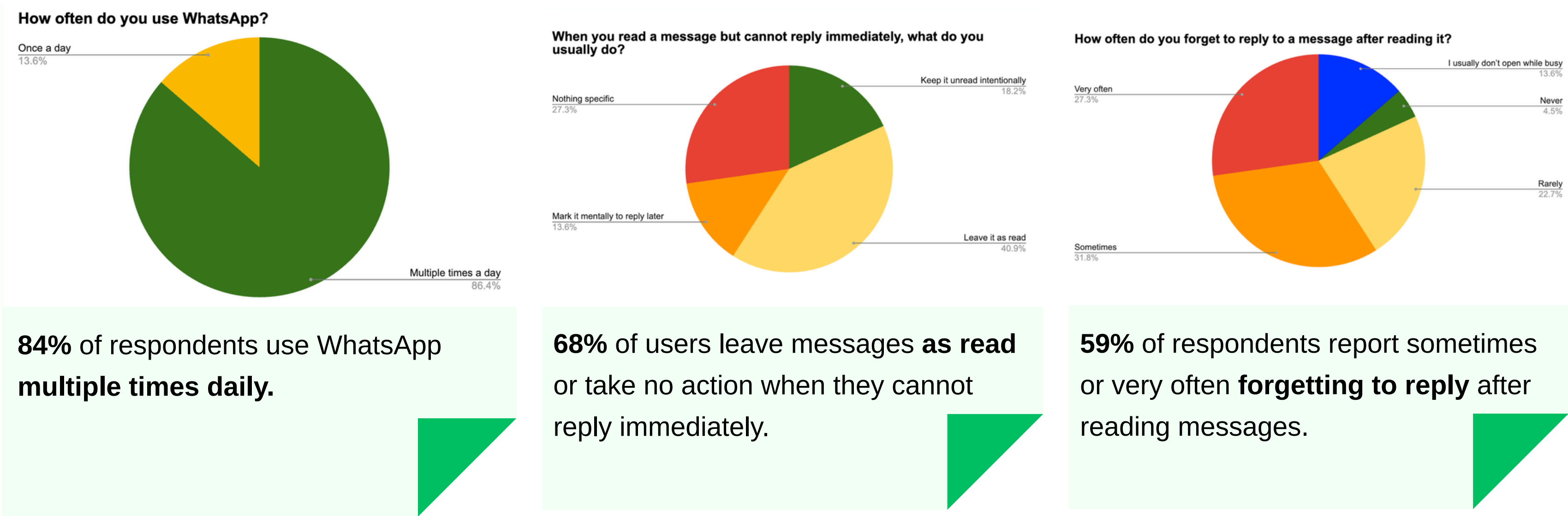
FAILURE WORKFLOW ⚠️ WHERE THE SYSTEM BREAKS



Users rely on the unread state as a reminder to reply later.
When a message is **opened, this reminder disappears** and the conversation can be forgotten.

USER RESEARCH FINDINGS

Insights from a survey of 22 WhatsApp users (ages 18–35) and behavioral analysis.



KEY INSIGHT

Users rely on **unread messages as a reminder** to reply later. When a message becomes **read**, this reminder **disappears**, making it easier to forget the conversation.

“Sometimes I read a message quickly and think I’ll reply later, but another conversation or task comes up and I forget.”

NAME

NANDHAKUMAR

JOB

SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

GENDER

MALE

AGE

28



Nandhakumar – Multitasking WhatsApp User

GOALS:

- Stay responsive in conversations with friends, family, and colleagues
- Quickly check incoming messages while multitasking
- Reply to important conversations later
- Uses WhatsApp for both personal and work-related conversations

BEHAVIORS:

- Uses WhatsApp multiple times daily
- Frequently checks messages while multitasking
- Sometimes opens messages just to quickly understand the context
- May switch to another conversation or task before replying

FRUSTRATIONS:

- Messages are marked as read once opened
- The **unread indicator disappears**, removing the reminder to reply
- Conversations move down the chat list, making it easier to forget replying.

SOLUTION EXPLORATION & PRIORITIZATION

GOAL

Increase the percentage of **read messages receiving a reply** within 24 hours by 20% within six months.

OPPORTUNITY

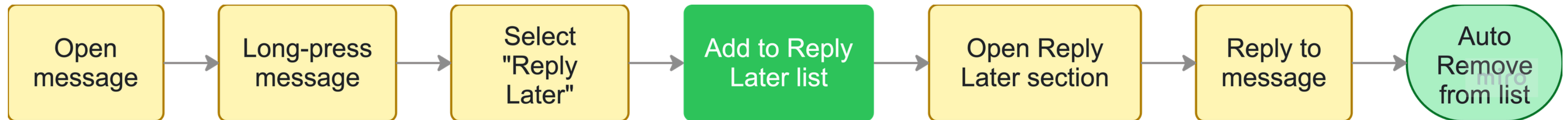
Users **rely on the unread state as a reminder**, but this reminder disappears once the message is opened.

SOLUTION	DESCRIPTION	IMPACT	EFFORT
★ Reply Later Tab (Chosen Solution)	Users can mark a message as Reply Later, adding it to a dedicated list where conversations can be revisited and replied to later.	High	Medium
Remind Me Later (Time-based Reminder)	Users can set a specific reminder time (e.g., later today or tomorrow) and WhatsApp sends a notification prompting them to reply.	Medium	Medium

KEY INSIGHT

Higher impact because it keeps conversations visible **without relying on notifications**.

REPLY LATER FEATURE FLOW



Prototype link: <https://salt-launch-00706173.figma.site/>

EXPECTED BUSINESS OUTCOMES

- Increase **Reply Completion Rate** by 20% within 6 months
- Increase conversations that **receive replies**
- Reduce **forgotten replies** in personal chats
- Increase **user engagement and session depth**

SUCCESS METRICS

Metric Type	Metric Name	Definition	Why It Matters
● Primary Metric	Reply Completion Rate	% of read messages that receive a reply within 24 hours after being opened.	Directly measures whether the feature reduces forgotten replies
● Secondary Metric	Reply Later Feature Adoption Rate	% of users who mark at least one message as Reply Later	Indicates whether users discover and adopt the feature
● Secondary Metric	Average Reply Time (Marked Messages)	Average time taken to reply to messages marked as Reply Later	Shows whether the feature helps users respond faster to postponed messages.
● Guardrail Metric	Reply Later Abandonment Rate	% of messages marked Reply Later that never receive a reply	Ensures users are not postponing conversations indefinitely
● Guardrail Metric	Reminder Frequency per User	Average number of Reply Later reminders or visual indicators shown per user per day.	Ensures the feature does not create excessive reminders or UI clutter

RISKS & MITIGATIONS

RISK	WHY IT HAPPENS	MITIGATION
Low feature discoverability	Users may not notice the "Reply Later" option in the long-press menu	Show onboarding tooltip or in-app hint when users first long-press a message
Users mark messages but never reply	Users postpone conversations and forget to revisit them	Show subtle badges or reminders for pending Reply Later messages
Reply Later list becomes cluttered	Users may mark too many conversations	Sort messages by oldest pending reply and highlight priority conversations
Notification or reminder fatigue	Too many reminders may annoy users	Allow users to control reminder frequency or disable reminders



THANK YOU

Happy to discuss trade-offs, experimentation plan, or rollout strategy.



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